Automate delivery follow-up

Product and Delivery Teams | Intermediate

Session M7-06 | 3 hours

What is an automation?

An **automation** is a saved prompt plus a **trigger**, a set of **tools**, and an **enabled** state. When the trigger fires, the agent runs the prompt.

- **Trigger and cadence:** manual (you click run), a schedule (hourly, daily, or weekly), or a repository event such as a new issue or pull request. Cloud and local automations offer different triggers; check current docs.
- **Local scope:** runs on your machine, only while the app can run it. Cloud automations are a separate type that need Copilot cloud agent enabled for the repository.
- **Enabled state:** an enabled automation can fire. A disabled one can't.

Automation, saved prompt, or Actions workflow?

	Saved prompt	Copilot automation	GitHub Actions workflow
Starts	You, each time	Trigger or you	Repository event or schedule
Runs	In your session	An agent run with chosen tools	Deterministic steps on a runner
Output	Varies	Varies; needs review	Same steps, same result
Best for	Repeated asks you watch	Recurring judgment work, like a draft update	Builds, tests, deploys

Use Actions when the job must be exact. Use an automation when the job needs reading and writing.

Source reliability

A draft is only as good as its inputs.

- Live issues beat copied status files.
- A reviewed parent result beats chat memory.
- When sources disagree, the draft should say so, not pick one.
- A claim without a source gets cut.

A useful update, and why drafts go wrong

A useful update says **what changed, what is stuck, who owns it, and what happens next.** It is short and every claim has a source.

Drafts go wrong when:

- inputs are stale or incomplete;
- the model fills gaps with a guess or a cause;
- the prompt asks for tone, not facts;
- nobody reviews it.

Scheduling: pros and cons

Pros: no one forgets; consistent timing.

Cons: repeats mistakes unattended; costs usage; stale inputs produce confident wrong drafts; someone must own it.

That's why this lab stays manual.

Start from authoritative state

Use:

- the live GitHub issues;
- the reviewed Session M7-05 parent result.

Skip static handoffs. They drift from the platform state.

Define the automation

Field	Decision
Trigger and cadence	Manual; no schedule
Authoritative inputs	Live issues and parent result
Permitted output	One draft stakeholder update
Prohibited side effects	No posts, messages, edits, or external writes
Reviewer	Named human role
Stop conditions	Named hard boundaries
Current state	Enabled or disabled

Review run details on the platform

Inspect run status, identifiers, timing, usage, and supporting results on the platform.

Create one manual automation

```
Read the approved status-visibility GitHub issues and the reviewed Session M7-05
parent result. Draft one stakeholder update from supported issue state. Name
unresolved exceptions and owners. Boundary: draft only.
```

Use the minimum GitHub read tools.

Review the first run

- Trace every claim to an issue or the parent result.
- Keep gaps or conflicts in the source information visible.
- Reject unsupported causes and forecasts.
- Check that no prohibited side effect occurred.
- Choose Keep, Revise, Disable, or Pause.

Change one approved input

Update the requester-access training issue with the approved synthetic results.

Retrieve the issue again. Then run the same automation.

Check that the new draft differs only because of the approved issue change.

Stakeholder update

State:

- the reporting scope;
- supported status changes;
- unresolved exceptions and owners;
- the review decision;
- the next action.

A person shares the update.

Choose one authoritative system

Use **GitHub** when issues and agent work live there.

Use **Azure Boards** when the delivery backlog lives there.

Do not maintain competing status fields.

Scheduling stays disabled

The core lab uses supervised manual runs.

Enable a cadence only after separate sign-off. Update the current state when the automation is enabled or disabled.

Lab deliverable

1. Concise automation definition
2. Reviewed stakeholder update

Run records stay on the platform.